

improved customer service. Application Organizational Needs and Benefits IT Asset Management Automate asset inventory and maximize asset utilization; drive improvements in overall IT workflow and efficiency with real-time data and floor map views of resources so workers can quickly find what they need when they need it.

IT Asset Security Prevent loss and theft of valuable equipment and monitor, in real-time, the location of equipment containing sensitive and valuable information; receive alerts when assets move into and out of areas of interest.

Staff Productivity Optimize workflow and improve efficiency by quickly locating mobile IT equipment (i.e., notebooks, handhelds, monitors, projectors, printers, etc.). IT Asset Maintenance Locate assets for break/fix and preventative maintenance, and understand usage patterns to drive the appropriate asset and staff allocation. Recently emerging from companies such as PanGo Networks are software-only location-aware solutions and active RFID asset-tracking applications operating on standard 802.11 WLAN infrastructures.

These software-only Wi-Fi-based active RFID applications bring to enterprise environments the ability to:

1. Track IT equipment affixed with 802.11-based active RFID tags
2. Identify the location of devices that incorporate 802.11 Network Interface Cards (NICs) such as PCs and PDAs; and
3. Integrate location information into asset management and workflow systems.

The process of implementing 802.11-based RFID for asset tracking begins by conducting an initial survey of the environment that captures RF fingerprints (based on signal strength readings) at various important places throughout the facility or campus. The principle is that a unique RF fingerprint can be